



Health Command & Avatar Tethering Framework

A State-Led Model for Responsible AI Integration in Clinical Care

Submitted in Response to: HHS RFI — Accelerating the Adoption and Use of Artificial Intelligence in Clinical Care

Executive Overview & National Relevance

Purpose

This brief presents the **Health Command Intermediary AI Framework**, currently under legislative consideration in Alabama (SB97) and Kentucky (SB175), as a structured, state-governed model for responsible AI deployment in clinical care. The system is designed to align with HHS objectives concerning:

- Regulatory clarity
- Payment modernization
- Rural health sustainability
- Workforce augmentation
- Research and implementation science

Health Command integrates a patented methodology known as **Avatar Tethering**, which enhances contextual care coordination and sustainable engagement within an AI-supported healthcare ecosystem.

The National Challenge

Rural healthcare systems face accelerating pressures:

- Physician and specialist shortages
- Uncompensated emergency department utilization
- Aging populations
- Payment model inefficiencies
- Increasing telehealth competition from out-of-state providers

Simultaneously, AI innovation is advancing rapidly without uniform governance structures or value-aligned reimbursement pathways.

A scalable, governance-based framework is required to prevent fragmented adoption and unintended consequences.

Health Command: System Architecture

Health Command operates as a **non-autonomous AI intermediary platform** that:

- Performs triage and care navigation
- Supports chronic disease monitoring
- Routes patients to licensed providers
- Assists workforce documentation and workflow
- Integrates telehealth escalation pathways

Licensed clinicians retain authority for diagnosis, prescribing, and treatment decisions. The system is structured to operate under state oversight and in compliance with federal privacy, civil rights, and interoperability standards.

Regulatory Alignment & Payment Modernization

Regulatory Crosswalk Summary

Health Command aligns with major HHS domains:

HIPAA / Privacy

- Business associate frameworks
- Data minimization
- Role-based access
- Audit logging

FDA (Clinical Decision Support)

- Non-autonomous workflow support
- Human-in-the-loop oversight
- Transparent triage logic

CMS Payment Policy

- Supports value-based care
- Reduces ER overutilization
- Enhances preventive engagement

Civil Rights & Bias Mitigation

- Human oversight safeguards
- Algorithmic auditing capacity
- Governance transparency

This structure supports a proportionate risk-based regulatory posture.

Reimbursement & Financial Sustainability

Legacy fee-for-service models often:

- Disincentivize prevention
- Delay adoption of innovation
- Generate spending inefficiencies

Health Command supports payment modernization by:

- Diverting non-emergent ER visits
- Enhancing chronic disease adherence
- Enabling earlier intervention
- Facilitating in-network routing

Avatar Tethering Sustainability Model

Avatar Tethering allows contextual linking of:

- Patients
- Licensed providers
- Institutions
- Educational partners
- Approved sponsor entities

This model creates modest, scalable revenue support for rural healthcare institutions without increasing patient out-of-pocket costs.

Revenue mechanisms are structured for transparency and state oversight to avoid inducement or volume-based distortions.

Research, Demonstration & National Pilot Potential

Research & Development Opportunities

Health Command provides measurable performance indicators suitable for:

- CMMI demonstration projects
- CRADAs
- Applied implementation science research
- Rural transformation pilots

Metrics include:

- ER diversion rates
- Time-to-escalation
- Cost-per-episode reductions
- Workforce efficiency improvements
- Patient engagement and satisfaction

Addressing HHS RFI Questions

Health Command directly addresses:

- Regulatory ambiguity through structured governance
- Payment inertia through value-based integration
- Interoperability through FHIR-compatible APIs
- Workforce shortages via AI augmentation
- Patient access barriers through remote triage and escalation

Why This Framework Is a Strong National Starting Point

Health Command offers:

- State-guided oversight
- Licensed clinician authority preservation
- Rural sustainability focus
- Patent-protected infrastructure
- Interoperable architecture
- Measurable outcome metrics

Rather than fragmented private deployment, this framework provides a coordinated, scalable structure that HHS could evaluate for:

- Multi-state pilot implementation
- Rural Health Transformation alignment
- Federal demonstration programs
- Payment model modernization testing

It preserves human clinicians, strengthens local institutions, and supports responsible AI deployment at modest implementation cost.

Conclusion

The Health Command and Avatar Tethering framework represents a state-led, governance-based model for AI integration that aligns directly with HHS's regulatory, reimbursement, and research objectives.

We respectfully submit this framework for federal review and welcome further dialogue regarding potential pilot evaluation, demonstration authority, or cooperative partnership.